IGCSE 0607 Practice Questions — E10.3

Discrete and continuous data

Total Questions: 6 — **Total Marks:** 26 Marks

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1 A sports analyst collects data during a football match.

(a) State whether the number of goals scored in the match is discrete or continuous.

..... **[1]**

(b) State whether the mass of the football is discrete or continuous.

..... **[1]**

(c) State whether the time taken to complete the match is discrete or continuous.

..... **[1]**

(d) State whether the temperature on the pitch is discrete or continuous.

..... **[1]**

2 A student collects data about a local park for a science project.

(a) Explain the mathematical difference between discrete and continuous data.

.....

.....

..... **[2]**

(b) The student measures the lengths of 50 leaves to the nearest millimetre.

(i) State whether the true length of a leaf is discrete or continuous.

..... **[1]**

(ii) Explain why measuring the lengths to the nearest millimetre does not make the variable discrete.

.....

..... **[1]**

3 Data is collected about the members of an athletics club.

(a) State whether each of the following variables is discrete or continuous.

(i) The number of members in the club.

..... **[1]**

(ii) The exact distance a member jumps in the long jump.

..... **[1]**

(b) The shoe sizes of the members are recorded.
Shoe sizes are available in sizes such as $7, 7.5, 8, 8.5, 9$.
A student claims that because these shoe sizes include decimal values, the data is continuous.
Explain why the student is incorrect.

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..... **[2]**

4 A student collects data for a statistics project.
For each of the variables below, state whether the data collected is discrete or continuous.

(a) The number of goals scored in a football match.

..... **[1]**

(b) The mass of a football.

..... **[1]**

(c) The volume of water in a swimming pool.

..... **[1]**

(d) The number of people swimming in a pool.

..... **[1]**

5 A scientist measures the lengths of 50 worms and counts the number of spots on each worm. The frequency table shows the data collected for the number of spots.

Number of spots	$0-4$	$5-9$	$10-14$	$15-19$
Frequency	12	18	14	6

(a) State which of the two variables, length or number of spots, is continuous.

..... **[1]**

(b) The length of one worm is recorded as 14.5 cm, correct to the nearest millimetre.

(i) Write down the lower bound of this length.

..... *cm* **[1]**

(ii) Write down the upper bound of this length.

..... *cm* **[1]**

(c) Using the frequency table, write down the class width for the $5-9$ class.

..... **[2]**

6 Two sets of data are collected during a fitness test.
Data Set A is the exact time, t seconds, taken by athletes to run a race.
Data Set B is the number of push-ups, n, completed by the athletes.

(a) Data Set A is grouped into classes such as $10 \leq t < 12$.
Data Set B is grouped into classes such as $10 - 19$.
Explain why the classes for Data Set A use inequalities while the classes for Data Set B use a hyphen.

.....

..... **[2]**

(b) A student decides to draw a histogram to represent Data Set B. One of the classes is $20 - 29$.

(i) State the lower and upper class boundaries that must be used for this class on the horizontal axis of the histogram.

Lower = ... , Upper = ... **[1]**

(ii) Calculate the class width used for the frequency density calculation.

..... **[1]**

(c) Continuous data can theoretically take any value within a range.
Give an example of a continuous variable that is practically recorded as discrete data in everyday life.

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..... **[1]**